

**Board 1**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 5 4  
 ♥ J 10 7 2  
 ♦ 9 6 5  
 ♣ J

♠ K Q 6

♥ K Q 4

♦ A 7 4

♣ K 10 9 6



♠ J 10 9 2

♥ 9 6 3

♦ Q 10 8 2

♣ 3 2

♠ 3

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3

♣ A Q 8 7 5 4

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass        | 1NT   | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass        | 4♣    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass        | 5♦    | Pass | 6♣    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♣ by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner responds 3♣. What is your next bid?

Partner's jump to 3♣ shows at least 5 ♣s and slam interest. Your hand is good enough to encourage that interest so you bypass 3NT and say 4♣. Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

That is Blackwood. You admit to one Ace and partner bids 6♣.

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 5 2  
 ♥ 5  
 ♦ K 9 8 7 5  
 ♣ A 7 2

♠ K 9 6  
 ♥ K J 6 4  
 ♦ A Q 4  
 ♣ Q J 5



♠ J 10 4 3  
 ♥ A 10  
 ♦ J 10 3 2  
 ♣ K 8 4

♠ Q 8  
 ♥ Q 9 8 7 3 2  
 ♦ 6  
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| 1 ♦          | 1NT          | Pass        | 2 ♥          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 2 ♥ by South |              |             |              |

The bidding has been as shown.

A 1NT overcall is almost the same as a 1NT opening. The range is increased to 15-18, but the main difference is that you **must** have the opponent's suit adequately stopped. Here you certainly have the stopper so you bid 1NT. Partner responds 2 ♥.

And the responses are the same also. Partner's 2 ♥ bid is a signoff bid, often called a "drop dead" bid. So even though you really like the ♥s you pass.

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 3  
♥ Q 6 4  
♦ J 10 9 8 2  
♣ K J 3

♠ A J 8

♥ K 9 5 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ A Q 9



♠ 9 5 4

♥ A J 10 7

♦ K 6 3

♣ 6 5 4

♠ K Q 10 7 2

♥ 8 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 10 8 7 2

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

With a balanced 20 point hand you open 2NT.

Partner responds 3♠.

Partner is showing a 5-card ♠ suit and at least 5 points. This is a forcing bid; you are to choose between 3NT and 4♠, depending on your ♠ holding. With three of them you bid 4♠.

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 4 2  
♥ 10 8 7 4  
♦ Q 8 5  
♣ A J 2

♠ K 9 8 3

♥ K Q 2

♦ 10 7 4

♣ 9 5 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 10 7 5

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A 9 3

♣ K 10 7

♠ A 6

♥ A J 6

♦ K J 6 2

♣ Q 8 6 4

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 8 points. Even if partner has the maximum 17 it would only add to 25, which is probably not enough to make game. You should pass.

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 5 4  
♥ J 10 6 5 4  
♦ A K  
♣ 9 7

♠ K 9 3

♥ K Q 2

♦ 10 9 7 4

♣ J 5 3



♠ 8 7 6

♥ 8 3

♦ J 6 5 2

♣ A 8 6 2

♠ A Q 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ Q 8 3

♣ K Q 10 4

The bidding has been as shown.

With 9 points you have just enough strength for an invitation. So you bid 2NT. Partner then says 3NT and everybody passes.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1NT          |
| Pass         | 2NT          | Pass        | 3NT          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by South |              |             |              |